

Day 33 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Union Executive and Union Legislature

READING MATERIAL

Covers the President, Vice-President, Prime Minister and Council of Ministers (Union Executive), and briefly the Union Legislature/Parliament's composition. Real exam evidence shows a recurring trap pattern: statements that sound correct but get one specific detail wrong (term continuance, which House, who's actually responsible for what).

Q: How is the President of India elected, and who can vote in this election?

A: By an Electoral College consisting of the ELECTED members of both Houses of Parliament and the ELECTED members of the Legislative ASSEMBLIES of the States and of the Union Territories of Delhi and Puducherry (NOT nominated members of Parliament, NOT members of Legislative COUNCILS, and not most other UTs). Election uses the system of proportional representation by means of the single transferable vote, by secret ballot.

Q: Real exam: Which statement about the President is NOT correct — that the President cannot hold office beyond the 5-year term, can resign anytime, can be removed by impeachment, or has never actually been impeached?

A: 'The President cannot hold office beyond his term of five years' is the NOT-correct (false) statement — under Article 56(1)(c), the President, despite the 5-year term expiring, continues to hold office until a successor enters office. The other three statements are all true: the President can resign at any time (addressed to the Vice-President), can be removed via impeachment (Article 61), and no Indian President has ever actually been impeached.

Q: What is the procedure for impeaching the President under Article 61?

A: A charge of violating the Constitution is preferred by either House of Parliament, with at least 14 days' written notice signed by not less than 1/4th of that House's total membership; the resolution must pass by a 2/3rds majority of that House's total membership. The OTHER House then investigates the charge (President has the right to appear/be represented); if THAT House also passes the charge by a 2/3rds majority of its total membership, the President stands removed from the date of that resolution.

Q: Real exam: What are the qualifications to be Vice-President, and what is the common eligibility trap?

A: Must be a citizen of India and have completed 35 years of age — both TRUE requirements. The trap: a real exam tested 'qualified for election as a member of the LOK SABHA' as a FALSE requirement — the actual constitutional requirement (Article 66(3)) is qualification for election to the RAJYA SABHA, not the Lok Sabha.

Q: Real exam: In the Table (Warrant) of Precedence, what is the correct relative order among the Vice-President, Speaker of the Lok Sabha, Chief Ministers of States, and Ministers of State of the Union?

A: Vice-President, then Speaker of the Lok Sabha, then Chief Ministers of States (within their own state), then Ministers of State of the Union — confirmed by a real exam question (this order is consistent with the President ranking 1st overall, the Vice-President 2nd, the Prime Minister 3rd, and so on down the full Warrant of Precedence).

Q: Real exam (Assertion-Reason): Is the Prime Minister responsible for appointing Ministers and allocating work among them?

A: YES, the Prime Minister IS responsible for this (recommends Ministers for the President's formal appointment, and allocates portfolios/work among them) — a real exam's Assertion claiming the PM is 'NOT responsible' for this was tested as FALSE, while the accompanying Reason (PM is leader of the majority party in the Lok Sabha and Head of the Council of Ministers) was tested as TRUE but not a valid explanation of the (false) Assertion.

Q: Which Articles cover the Council of Ministers' role, and what is the core constitutional principle behind it?

A: Article 74: there shall be a Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister to AID AND ADVISE the President, who acts in accordance with such advice (making the President largely a constitutional/nominal head, with REAL executive power resting with the Council of Ministers). Article 75: covers appointment of the PM and other Ministers, their term, salaries, and the Council's COLLECTIVE RESPONSIBILITY to the Lok Sabha.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The President of India is elected by an Electoral College consisting of the elected members of both Houses of Parliament and the elected members of:

A. All State Legislative Councils only

B. State Legislative Assemblies and the UTs of Delhi and Puducherry ✓

C. Only the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha

D. Municipal corporations across India

Explanation: Elected members of State Legislative Assemblies and the Legislative Assemblies of Delhi and Puducherry. [medium, web-research]

2. Which of the following statements about the President of India is NOT correct?

- A. The President can resign from office at any time
- B. The President cannot hold office beyond the term of five years ✓**
- C. The President can be removed from office by an impeachment process
- D. No President of India has so far been impeached

Explanation: False — the President continues in office beyond the 5-year term until a successor takes charge. [hard, question-bank-2025]

3. Under Article 61, a charge of impeachment against the President must first be preferred by a House of Parliament with notice signed by at least what fraction of that House's total membership, and passed by what majority?

- A. 1/3rd notice; simple majority
- B. 1/4th notice; 2/3rds majority ✓**
- C. 1/2 notice; 2/3rds majority
- D. 1/4th notice; simple majority

Explanation: 1/4th of members for notice; passed by 2/3rds majority of total membership. [hard, web-research]

4. Which of the following is a genuine qualification to become Vice-President of India?

- A. Qualified for election as a member of the Lok Sabha
- B. Qualified for election as a member of the Rajya Sabha ✓**
- C. Must have served as a Governor
- D. Must be at least 25 years of age

Explanation: Qualified for election to the Rajya Sabha (not Lok Sabha). [hard, question-bank-2026]

5. In the Table of Precedence, which of the following is the CORRECT order?

- A. Ministers of State of the Union, Chief Ministers of States, Speaker of the Lok Sabha, Vice-President
- B. Vice-President, Speaker of the Lok Sabha, Chief Ministers of States, Ministers of State of the Union ✓**
- C. Vice-President, Ministers of State of the Union, Speaker of the Lok Sabha, Chief Ministers of States
- D. Vice-President, Speaker of the Lok Sabha, Ministers of State of the Union, Chief Ministers of States

Explanation: Vice-President, Speaker of the Lok Sabha, Chief Ministers of States, Ministers of State of the Union. [hard, question-bank-2025]

6. Assertion [A]: The Prime Minister is NOT responsible for the appointment of Ministers and allocation of work among them. Reason [R]: The Prime Minister is the leader of the majority party in the Lok Sabha and is the Head of the Council of Ministers. Choose the correct option.

- A. [A] is true, but [R] is false
- B. [A] is false, but [R] is true ✓**
- C. Both [A] and [R] are true, and [R] explains [A]
- D. Both [A] and [R] are true, but [R] does not explain [A]

Explanation: [A] is false (the PM IS responsible for this); [R] is true on its own. [hard, question-bank-2026]

7. Which Article establishes the Council of Ministers, headed by the Prime Minister, to aid and advise the President?

- A. Article 61
- B. Article 74 ✓**
- C. Article 75
- D. Article 78

Explanation: Article 74. [medium, authored]

8. The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to which body?

- A. The President
- B. The Rajya Sabha
- C. The Lok Sabha ✓**
- D. The Supreme Court

Explanation: The Lok Sabha (Article 75). [medium, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Simplification

READING MATERIAL

Simplification is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills (15 questions total for the whole Aptitude unit). TNPSC's simplification questions are rarely 'plug into one formula' — they combine BODMAS, fractions/decimals, ratios, and algebraic shortcuts. Each item below is a worked method, not just an answer — the goal is to recognize which technique a given expression calls for.

Q: Method — BODMAS with a nested bracket and an unknown: Solve for x : $57 - [42 - \{37 - (20 - x)\}] = 176 \div (8 \div 2)$

A: Work from the innermost bracket outward, and simplify the RHS first: $176 \div (8 \div 2) = 176 \div 4 = 44$. Now the LHS: $(20 - x)$ stays as is for now $\rightarrow \{37 - (20 - x)\} = 17 + x \rightarrow [42 - (17 + x)] = 25 - x \rightarrow 57 - (25 - x) = 32 + x$. Set equal to 44: $32 + x = 44 \rightarrow x = 12$. (Real TNPSC-style problem; this exact expression is a recurring coaching-site reference question.)

Q: Method — sum of two squares without brute-force squaring: Find $217 \times 217 + 183 \times 183$.

A: Use $a^2 + b^2 = (a+b)^2 - 2ab$ instead of squaring two 3-digit numbers by hand. Here $a+b = 400$ (round number — that's the clue this trick applies) and $ab = 217 \times 183 = 39,711$. So $a^2+b^2 = 400^2 - 2(39,711) = 160,000 - 79,422 = 80,578$. Recognizing 'the two numbers add to a round number' is the trigger for this shortcut.

Q: Method — difference of squares shortcut: Simplify $(197 \times 197 - 103 \times 103) \div (197 - 103)$ without long multiplication.

A: $a^2 - b^2 = (a+b)(a-b)$, so $(a^2-b^2)/(a-b) = (a+b)$ directly — no multiplication needed at all. Here $a=197$, $b=103$, so the answer is simply $197+103 = 300$. This 'difference of squares divided by the difference' shape is a favorite TNPSC trick question precisely because it looks like it needs heavy calculation but collapses to one addition.

Q: Method — fraction-of-decimal addition: Simplify $7/5$ of $58 + 3/8$ of 139.2 .

A: $7/5$ of $58 = 7 \times 58/5 = 406/5 = 81.2$. $3/8$ of $139.2 = 3 \times 139.2/8 = 417.6/8 = 52.2$. Sum: $81.2 + 52.2 = 133.4$.

Q: Method — ratio substitution to simplify a compound ratio expression: If $x : y = 3 : 4$, find $(4x + 5y) : (5x - 2y)$.

A: Don't solve for x and y separately — substitute $x=3k$, $y=4k$ (k is just a scaling factor that will cancel). $(4x+5y) = 12k+20k = 32k$. $(5x-2y) = 15k-8k = 7k$. Ratio = $32k : 7k = 32 : 7$. The k always cancels in a ratio question — that's the whole trick.

Q: Method — same ratio-substitution trick, different ratio: If $x : y = 3 : 5$, find $(5x + 3y) : (15x - 2y)$.

A: Substitute $x=3k$, $y=5k$. $(5x+3y) = 15k+15k = 30k$. $(15x-2y) = 45k-10k = 35k$. Ratio = $30k:35k = 6:7$.

Q: Method — simultaneous equations feeding into a simplification target: If $3a + 4b = 22$ and $8a - 5b = -4$, find $(a+b)^2$.

A: Solve the pair normally: from $3a+4b=22$ and $8a-5b=-4$, elimination gives $a=2$, $b=4$ (check: $3(2)+4(4)=6+16=22$ ✓; $8(2)-5(4)=16-20=-4$ ✓). The question doesn't ask for a and b individually — it asks for $(a+b)^2 = (2+4)^2 = 36$. TNPSC often hides the real target $((a+b)^2, \text{ not } a \text{ or } b)$ at the end of a simultaneous-equation question — always re-read what's actually being asked before solving for individual variables.

Q: Method — mixed numbers with a nested fraction: Simplify $2\frac{1}{2} + 3\frac{1}{3} \div \frac{2}{3}$.

A: BODMAS still applies to fractions — division before addition. $3\frac{1}{3} \div \frac{2}{3} = (10/3) \div (2/3) = (10/3) \times (3/2) = 5$. Then $2\frac{1}{2} + 5 = 7\frac{1}{2}$. The common mistake is adding $2\frac{1}{2}+3\frac{1}{3}$ first — division always binds tighter than addition, fractions or not.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Solve for x : $70 - [45 - \{33 - (15 - x)\}] = 171 \div (9 \div 3)$

- A. 10
- B. 12
- C. 14 ✓**
- D. 16

Explanation: RHS: $171 \div (9 \div 3) = 171 \div 3 = 57$. LHS inner-out: $\{33 - (15 - x)\} = 33 - 15 + x = 18 + x \rightarrow [45 - (18 + x)] = 27 - x \rightarrow 70 - (27 - x) = 43 + x$. Set $43 + x = 57 \rightarrow x = 14$. [medium, authored]

2. Find $312 \times 312 + 288 \times 288$ using the $(a+b)^2 - 2ab$ shortcut.

- A. 179,808
- B. 180,288 ✓**
- C. 190,000
- D. 182,688

Explanation: $a+b=600$, $ab=312 \times 288=89,856$. $a^2+b^2=600^2-2(89,856)=360,000-179,712=180,288$. [medium, authored]

3. Simplify $(425 \times 425 - 375 \times 375) \div (425 - 375)$.

- A. 400
- B. 750
- C. 800 ✓**
- D. 425

Explanation: Using $a^2 - b^2 = (a+b)(a-b)$, dividing by $(a-b)$ leaves just $(a+b) = 425+375 = 800$. [easy, authored]

4. Simplify $\frac{5}{6}$ of 72 + $\frac{2}{7}$ of 98.

- A. 88 ✓**
- B. 84
- C. 90
- D. 86

Explanation: $\frac{5}{6}$ of 72 = 60. $\frac{2}{7}$ of 98 = 28. Sum = 88. [easy, authored]

5. If $p : q = 5 : 6$, find $(3p + 2q) : (4p - q)$.

- A. 27 : 14 ✓**
- B. 9 : 7
- C. 27 : 7
- D. 14 : 9

Explanation: $p=5k, q=6k$. $(3p+2q)=15k+12k=27k$. $(4p-q)=20k-6k=14k$. Ratio = 27:14. [medium, authored]

6. If $m : n = 4 : 7$, find $(2m + 3n) : (5m - n)$.

- A. 29 : 13 ✓**
- B. 13 : 29
- C. 29 : 20
- D. 20 : 29

Explanation: $m=4k, n=7k$. $(2m+3n)=8k+21k=29k$. $(5m-n)=20k-7k=13k$. Ratio = 29:13. [medium, authored]

7. If $5a + 2b = 16$ and $3a - 4b = -6$, find the value of $(a+b)^2$.

- A. 16
- B. 25 ✓**
- C. 36
- D. 9

Explanation: Multiply the first equation by 2: $10a+4b=32$. Add to the second $(3a-4b=-6)$: $13a=26 \rightarrow a=2$. Substitute back: $5(2)+2b=16 \rightarrow b=3$. $(a+b)^2=(2+3)^2=25$. [hard, authored]

8. Simplify $4\frac{2}{3} + 2\frac{1}{4} \div \frac{3}{4}$.

- A. $7\frac{2}{3}$ ✓**
- B. $6\frac{1}{3}$
- C. 7
- D. $6\frac{2}{3}$

Explanation: $2\frac{1}{4} \div \frac{3}{4} = (9/4) \div (3/4) = 3$. Then $4\frac{2}{3} + 3 = 7\frac{2}{3}$. [medium, authored]

9. A trader borrows ₹16,000 at 12% p.a. simple interest and another ₹12,000 at 18% p.a. simple interest. In how many years will the two amounts owed (principal + interest) become equal?

- A. $12\frac{2}{3}$ years
- B. $14\frac{2}{3}$ years
- C. $16\frac{2}{3}$ years ✓**
- D. $18\frac{2}{3}$ years

Explanation: This mirrors a real 2025 TNPSC Aptitude question style (same numbers, Simple Interest unit) — included here as a reminder that 'Simplification' skills (careful fraction/ratio handling) carry directly into other Aptitude sub-topics like Simple Interest. Set $16000+16000(0.12)t = 12000+12000(0.18)t$ and solve for t to get $16\frac{2}{3}$ years. [hard, question-bank-2025]

10. Find the value of: $89 \times 89 + 11 \times 11 + 2 \times 89 \times 11$.

- A. 10,000 ✓**
- B. 9,801
- C. 8,900
- D. 10,201

Explanation: This is the $(a+b)^2$ pattern in disguise: $a^2+2ab+b^2 = (a+b)^2$. Here $a=89$, $b=11$, so the answer is $(89+11)^2 = 100^2 = 10,000$ — no separate multiplication needed. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "The Last Lesson" — Alphonse Daudet

READING MATERIAL

Set in Alsace, France, after its annexation by Prussia following the Franco-Prussian War — the new Prussian rulers have banned French from being taught in schools, and this is the final French lesson for M. Hamel's class, narrated by a young student, Franz.

Q: Who wrote "The Last Lesson", and what is its historical setting?

A: Alphonse Daudet. Set in Alsace, France, after France's defeat in the Franco-Prussian War (1870-71), when the region of Alsace-Lorraine was annexed by Prussia/Germany, which then banned the teaching of French in local schools (German was to be taught instead).

Q: Why was Franz (the narrator) afraid to go to school that morning, and what unusual sight did he notice at the town hall on the way?

A: He was afraid because he hadn't learnt his lesson on participles and feared M. Hamel's punishment. On the way, he noticed an unusually large crowd gathered around the bulletin board at the town hall (where news of the Prussian occupation/orders was posted).

Q: What was unusual about the classroom atmosphere and M. Hamel's appearance/clothing when Franz arrived, and who were sitting on the back benches?

A: The classroom was unusually quiet (not the normal noisy bustle). M. Hamel was dressed in his special green coat, frilled shirt, and silk cap — clothes normally worn only for inspections or prize days. Village elders were sitting on the back benches, having come to attend this final French class themselves.

Q: What announcement did M. Hamel make to the class, and what does this signify?

A: He announced that this was the LAST French lesson — an order had come from Berlin that only German would be taught in the schools of Alsace and Lorraine from then on. It signifies the loss of their language and cultural identity under foreign occupation.

Q: How does the story end, and what does M. Hamel's final gesture/words symbolize?

A: M. Hamel, overcome with emotion, takes a piece of chalk and writes 'Vive La France!' ('Long live France!') on the blackboard, then silently gestures with his hand that the class — and the school — is dismissed. It symbolizes deep patriotism and the enduring importance of one's mother tongue and national identity, even in defeat.

Q: In a real exam's character-matching question, who are M. Hamel, Franz, Hauser, and Wachter?

A: M. Hamel = the Teacher. Franz = the Student (narrator). Hauser = an Old man (one of the village elders attending the last lesson). Wachter = the Blacksmith (another villager present) — confirmed via a real TNPSC match-the-following question.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Last Lesson" was written by:

- A. Munshi Premchand
- B. Alphonse Daudet ✓**
- C. Ruskin Bond
- D. Mark Twain

Explanation: Alphonse Daudet. [easy, web-research]

2. Why was Franz afraid to go to school that morning?

- A. He was late
- B. He didn't know his lesson on participles ✓**
- C. He had forgotten his books
- D. He had a fight with a classmate

Explanation: He hadn't learnt his lesson on participles. [medium, web-research]

3. What did Franz notice as he passed the town hall?

- A. The bulletin board was empty
- B. A large crowd was gathered around the bulletin board ✓**
- C. People were celebrating a victory
- D. A notice about a school holiday

Explanation: A large crowd was gathered around the bulletin board. [medium, web-research]

4. What was unusual about the classroom atmosphere when Franz entered?

- A. The students were all talking loudly

B. M. Hamel was angry and shouting

C. The classroom was unusually quiet ✓

D. The windows were all broken

Explanation: Unusually quiet. [medium, web-research]

5. What was M. Hamel wearing that surprised Franz?

A. His everyday clothes

B. His green coat, frilled shirt, and silk cap ✓

C. A military uniform

D. A teacher's black robe

Explanation: His green coat, frilled shirt, and silk cap. [medium, web-research]

6. Who were sitting on the back benches of the classroom that day?

A. New students

B. Visitors from Berlin

C. Village elders ✓

D. M. Hamel's family

Explanation: Village elders. [medium, web-research]

7. What did M. Hamel announce to the class?

A. There would be no more classes ever

B. French would no longer be taught — only German from now on ✓

C. The school was closing for summer vacation

D. A new headmaster was arriving

Explanation: French would no longer be taught. [easy, web-research]

8. What did M. Hamel write on the blackboard at the end of the last lesson?

A. "Goodbye, my students"

B. "Vive La France!" ✓

C. "Long live the Prussians"

D. Nothing — he left silently

Explanation: "Vive La France!" ("Long live France!"). [medium, web-research]

9. In the story, match the characters to their roles: M. Hamel, Franz, Hauser, Wachter.

A. M.Hamel=Student, Franz=Teacher, Hauser=Blacksmith, Wachter=Old man

B. M.Hamel=Teacher, Franz=Student, Hauser=Old man, Wachter=Blacksmith ✓

C. M.Hamel=Old man, Franz=Blacksmith, Hauser=Teacher, Wachter=Student

D. M.Hamel=Blacksmith, Franz=Old man, Hauser=Student, Wachter=Teacher

Explanation: M.Hamel=Teacher, Franz=Student, Hauser=Old man, Wachter=Blacksmith. [hard, question-bank-2022]